

CISC 3667: Game Design and Development

Final Project: Check-In #1

Assigned: Thursday, October 1

Due: Tuesday, October 6, 2026, **before class (11:00 AM)**

Submission: Individual Submission to Brightspace

Purpose

This check-in is an opportunity to turn your early game idea into a more specific plan before we begin learning digital development. Your idea can still change as you learn new tools and test your design.

You are not expected to have built or programmed a prototype yet. You do not need to choose a development tool for this check-in.

What to Submit

Write a brief response to each section below. You may include a sketch or diagram if it helps explain your idea.

1. Game Concept

Describe the game you are considering. Include:

- Its genre, theme, or setting
- The experience you want players to have
- The player's main goal

If you are deciding between ideas, focus on the one you are most likely to develop and briefly mention your alternative.

2. Core Mechanic and Gameplay Loop

What will the player repeatedly **do** in your game? Describe a typical cycle of play:

1. What action does the player take?
2. How does the game respond or change?
3. What feedback does the player receive?
4. What encourages the player to continue playing?

Identify at least one meaningful decision or challenge within this loop.

3. Game Elements and Rules

Identify the main objects or entities in your game and briefly explain their roles. Then describe:

- At least one attribute or state that changes during play
- At least two rules or constraints
- How the player will know whether they are making progress
- How the game could end

4. Scope and Development Plan

Describe the **smallest playable version** of your idea that you could realistically create this semester. Identify:

- The features that are essential to make the game playable
- One or two features you could add later if time permits
- One feature you would cut if the project becomes too large

5. Questions and Next Steps

What part of your design are you least certain about? What would you want to test first once we begin building games?

List **two specific next steps** you plan to take during the upcoming digital development workshops. Include any question you would like feedback on.

Submission

Submit your own completed check-in to Brightspace by **11:00 AM on Tuesday, October 6**. This is an **individual final project**, so your response should describe your own game concept and plans.

Your design does not need to be final. The goal is to establish a clear, manageable starting point that you can develop and revise throughout the semester.